

Bay Sediment in Motion

StoryMap Design Process

Communication Capstone Symposium

Lilia Mourier | June 5th, 2026



UC SANTA BARBARA
Bren School of Environmental
Science & Management

SFEI | San Francisco
Estuary Institute

Client:
**The San Francisco
Estuary Institute
(SFEI)**



The background of the slide is a photograph of a wetland or estuary. In the foreground, there are dense, green, leafy plants. In the middle ground, a body of water reflects the light. In the background, there are tall, thin reeds or grasses. A white bird, possibly a egret or heron, is captured in mid-flight with its wings spread wide, positioned slightly to the right of the center. The overall lighting is soft, suggesting a dawn or dusk setting.

Client:

**The San Francisco
Estuary Institute
(SFEI)**

Technical sediment
transport report



Accessible StoryMap
experience

Design Challenges



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Complex system

The story spans multiple places, processes, and scales across Suisun and San Pablo Bay.



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Limited attention

Readers need a clear path through the material without feeling overwhelmed.

Solution 1A:
**Make the system
navigable through
a discovery-based
structure**

Explain why sediment
matters



Zoom in to understand
place-specific processes



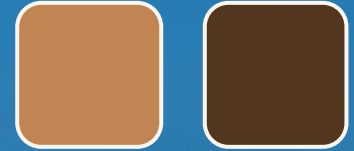
Zoom out to understand
big picture system
changes

Solution 1B: Use color as a navigation tool

Blues for
water



Browns for
mud



Greens for
marshes



Red & grey for
development





Solution 2:
Translate
technical language
into plain language

Resuspension → Stirred up

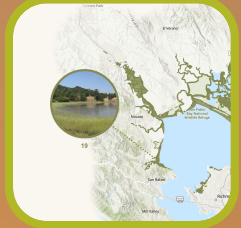
Accretion → Building upward

Tidal forcing → Tides moving sediment

Sediment sink → Where sediment settles or is stored

Solution 3: Design for attention and curiosity

Focus on one
process and
place at a time



Magnifying glass
view of
processes and
places



Blurred edges to
support the
feeling of
discovery





Bay Sediment In Motion

Explore key sediment transport processes, places,
and patterns in San Pablo and Suisun Bays

San Francisco Estuary Institute

May 15, 2026

